

June 2026

Category Review: Chips

Quantum Retail Analytics



Classification: Confidential



Executive Summary

01

Task 1: Customer Analytics

Older Singles/Couples and Mainstream customers drive chip sales; Kettle leads brands; 175g pack dominates.

02

Task 2: Store Trial Analysis

Stores 86 and 88 showed statistically significant sales uplift vs. control; Store 77 showed no significant change.

Commercial Impact

Strategy execution in high-performing trial stores has measurable revenue upside for Julia's category.

Key Recommendation

Expand Store 86 and 88 strategies; target Mainstream Older Singles/Couples with Kettle promotions.

Next Steps

6-month roadmap with targeted promotions, inventory optimisation, and trial store expansion plan.

Task 1: Customer Analytics – Who is Buying Chips and Why?

Life Stage & Segment

- Older Singles/Couples generate the highest chip sales volume.
- Mainstream customers account for the largest revenue share.
- Young Singles/Couples are an emerging growth segment.
- Premium and Budget customers show distinct brand preferences.

 Insert: Sales by Life Stage | Sales by Segment

Brand Performance

- Kettle is the #1 brand by sales value – strong premium positioning.
- Smiths and Doritos rank second and third respectively.
- Private label brands underperform vs. national brands.
- Kettle over-indexes with Mainstream and Premium customers.

 Insert: Top Brands by Sales Chart

Pack Size Insights

- 175g is the highest-selling pack size across all segments.
- 150g is the second-most popular – bulk and sharing packs lead.
- Smaller packs (40g–70g) drive impulse trial but low revenue.
- Optimise shelf space allocation toward 175g and 150g formats.

 Insert: Pack Size Sales Distribution Chart

Task 2: Store Trial Analysis – Measuring the Impact of the New Layout

Trial Store 77

Control Store: 41
p-value: 0.1031

Not Significant

No statistically significant sales uplift vs. control. Strategy should be reviewed before wider rollout.

Recommendation:

Continue monitoring. Investigate root causes of underperformance.

 Insert: Monthly Sales vs Control Chart

Trial Store 86

Control Store: 159
p-value: 0.0001

Significant (PASS)

Statistically significant uplift ($p < 0.05$). Trial strategy demonstrably increased sales performance.

Recommendation:

Recommend expanding the Store 86 strategy to similar store profiles.

 Insert: Monthly Sales vs Control Chart

Trial Store 88

Control Store: 159
p-value: < 0.001

Highly Significant (HIGHEST)

Highly significant uplift. Store 88 delivered the strongest trial result — robust evidence for expansion.

Recommendation:

Priority candidate for chain-wide rollout. Highest confidence in strategy effectiveness.

 Insert: Monthly Sales vs Control Chart

Statistical significance ($p < 0.05$) confirms that observed uplift is unlikely due to chance — providing Julia with high-confidence evidence for investment decisions.

Key Findings

- Older Singles/Couples and Mainstream customers are the highest-value chip buyers — confirmed by transaction data.
- Kettle leads brand sales; 175g pack is the dominant format — both should anchor Julia's ranging and promotional strategy.
- Stores 86 and 88 demonstrate statistically significant sales uplift — providing high-confidence evidence for category investment.

Business Impact

- Targeted segment and brand strategy can materially grow chip category revenue without requiring new SKUs or price investment.
- Proven store trial model provides a replicable measurement framework for future category initiatives across the network.

Next Steps

- Julia to approve 6-month promotional calendar and shelf planogram changes by end of Month 1.
- Quantum to deliver monthly analytics dashboards tracking KPIs against category targets throughout the rollout.

Quantum Recommendation: Expand the Store 86 and 88 strategy immediately — the data is clear, the evidence is robust, and the commercial opportunity is material.

Commercial Recommendations – Actions for Julia

Customer Strategy

- Prioritise promotional investment for Older Singles/Couples – highest-value segment.
- Sustain Mainstream customer focus: largest revenue contributor to the category.
- Increase Kettle brand visibility: premium placement, end-of-aisle positioning.
- Drive 175g and 150g pack prominence – stock depth and shelf allocation review.
- Pilot targeted digital promotions for Young Singles/Couples (emerging cohort).

Store Expansion Strategy

- Roll out Store 86 layout and ranging strategy to 10 comparable store formats.
- Prioritise Store 88 approach – highest statistical confidence, strongest uplift.
- Monitor Store 77 for 3 additional months before committing to expansion.
- Establish control-vs-trial measurement framework for all future store initiatives.
- Review trial store sales mix to identify the specific levers driving uplift.

Implementation Roadmap – 6-Month Action Plan

Month 1–2

Foundation & Setup



- Align Julia and category team on chip strategy priorities.
- Finalise planogram updates to prioritise 175g and 150g Kettle.
- Design promotional calendar targeting Mainstream Older Singles/Couples.
- Identify 10 stores for Phase 2 trial expansion (profiled to Stores 86/88).

KPIs: Shelf compliance rate | Promo plan signed off | Store selection finalised

Month 3–4

Execution & Expansion



- Launch targeted Kettle promotions across Mainstream Older Singles/Couples.
- Implement Store 86/88 layout strategy in 10 selected expansion stores.
- Begin monthly performance tracking vs. matched control stores.
- Run brand affinity research with Younger Singles/Couples cohort.

KPIs: Promo uplift % | Trial store sales growth vs control | NPS score

Month 5–6

Evaluate & Scale

- Evaluate trial store expansion results; assess statistical significance.
- Report outcomes to leadership; present ROI of chip category investment.
- Decide full rollout vs. further refinement based on p-value evidence.
- Re-assess Store 77 strategy and test alternative store execution approach.

KPIs: Revenue lift vs. benchmark | Stock turn rate | Rollout decision gate